A Trivial Matter Of The Mind

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At first, my mind was a blank slate, unable to discern the purpose of the oddly shaped plastic pieces that laid inside the gray bin before me. The vibrant colors were tantalizing and the need to peer further into the bin grew stronger, so I reached out towards them. The ridges beneath each block made it apparent that they were meant to fit together. The realization that I could create anything I desired with these blocks soon entered my mind. What was once a disarray of pieces scattered across the rug, were now the tools and components for creation.

Future afternoons would be spent piecing together those blocks into a marble run. The visual aspect of the run was crucial to me, but other factors were vital to the success of my personal project too. Without planning out a basic image of the run's layout, a quality foundation for the structure would've been virtually impossible. The marble run had an even weight distribution all throughout, established and ensured for a stable, sturdy structure that would surely support the weight of the marble that was to run through it. The swirl of the marble down the run was the final reward given to me, symbolizing the fruits of my labor.

For the first time in my life, I realized that to be able to bring forth my visions into something tangible can be amazing and the outcome is rewarding. Someone may view this hobby as trivial, but it is what made all the difference to me. I could mess up, fix what I did wrong, or just start all over from scratch and either way, it was something that I created with my own hands. These moments are what lead me to believe that a free-thinking, independent engineer with a tenacity to solve challenges and reach objectives — is the engineer I will be.